INCH-POUND

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30 September 1988

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

BEEF PATTIES IN BROTH, THERMOSTABILIZED, TRAY PACK

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers beef patties in broth, thermostabilized in tray pack cans for use by the Department of Defense as a component of operational rations.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents.

2.1.1 Specifications, standards, and handbooks. The following specifications, standards, and handbooks form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents shall be those listed in the issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DODISS) and supplement thereto, cited in the solicitation (see 6.1).

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be used in improving this document should be addressed to: U.S. Army Natick Research, Development, and Engineering Center, Natick, MA 01760-5018 by using the Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

AMSC N/A FSC 8940

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SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

PPP-B-636 - Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard

MILITARY

MIL-L-1497 - Labeling of Metal Cans for Subsistence Items
MIL-L-35078 - Loads, Unit: Preparation of Semiperishable Subsistence Items; Clothing, Personal Equipment and Equipage; General Specification for
MIL-C-44340 - Can, Tray Pack

STANDARDS

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage
MIL-STD-900 - Bacterial Standards for Starches, Flours, Cereals, Alimentary Pastes, Dry Milks and Sugars Used in the Preparation of Thermostabilized Foods for the Armed Forces

(Unless otherwise indicated, copies of federal and military specifications, standards, and handbooks are available from the Standardization Documents Order Desk, Building 4D, 700 Robbins Avenue, Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094.)

2.1.2 Other Government documents, drawings, and publications. The following other Government documents, drawings, and publications form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues are those cited in the solicitation.

ENVIRONMENTAL PROTECTION AGENCY (EPA)

National Primary Drinking Water Regulations

(Copies are available from the Office of Drinking Water, Environmental Protection Agency, WH550D, 401 M Street, S.W., Washington, DC 20460.)

U.S. DEPARTMENT OF AGRICULTURE (USDA)

Meat and Poultry Inspection Regulations

(Copies are available from the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402-0001.)

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Institutional Meat Purchase Specifications (IMPS) for Fresh Beef, Series 100

(Copies are available from the Director, Livestock and Seed Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, Room 2603, South Building, P.O. Box 96456, Washington, DC 20090-6456.)

U.S. Standards for Condition of Food Containers

(Copies are available from the Chairman, Condition of Container Committee, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, Room 2506, South Building, P.O. Box 96456, Washington, DC 20090-6456.)

USDA Northern Regional Research Laboratory Odor and Flavor Intensity Scoring Scale of the Cereal Panel Odor and Flavor Evaluation System

(Copies are available from the USDA Northern Laboratory Research Center (ARS-USDA), 1815 North University, Peoria, IL 61604.)

U.S. DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH AND HUMAN SERVICES (HHS)

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder (21 CFR Parts 1-199)

(Copies are available from the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402-0001.)

2.2 Non-Government publications. The following documents form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of the documents which are DoD adopted are those listed in the issue of the DoDISS cited in the solicitation. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of documents not listed in the DODISS are the issues of the documents cited in the solicitation (see 6.1).

AMERICAN ASSOCIATION OF CEREAL CHEMISTS (AACC)

Approved Methods of the American Association of Cereal Chemists

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Association of Cereal Chemists, 3340 Pilot Knob Road, St. Paul, MN 55121.)

AMERICAN DEHYDRATED ONION AND GARLIC ASSOCIATION (ADOGA)

Official Standards and Methods of the American Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Association for Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Products

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Association, 650 California Street, Suite 800, San Francisco, CA 94108.)

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AMERICAN OIL CHEMISTS SOCIETY

Official and Tentative Methods of the American Oil Chemists Society

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Oil Chemists Society, 508 South Sixth Street, Champaign, IL 61820.)

AMERICAN SOCIETY FOR TESTING AND MATERIALS (ASTM)

D 3330 - Peel Adhesion of Pressure-Sensitive Tape

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103-1187.)

AOAC INTERNATIONAL

Official Methods of Analysis of the AOAC

(Application for copies should be addressed to the AOAC International, 2200 Wilson Boulevard, Suite 400-CD, Arlington, VA 22201-3301.)

NATIONAL ACADEMY OF SCIENCES

Food Chemicals Codex

(Application for copies should be addressed to the National Academy Press, 2101 Constitution Avenue, N.W., Washington, DC 20418.)

(Non-Government standards and other publications are normally available from the organizations that prepare or distribute the documents. These documents also may be available in or through libraries or other informational services.)

2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this document and the references cited herein, the text of this document takes precedence. Nothing in this document, however, supersedes applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 First article. When specified (see 6.1), a sample shall be subjected to first article inspection (see 6.2) in accordance with 4.4.

3.2 Ingredients. All ingredients shall be clean, sound, wholesome, and free from foreign material, evidence of rodent or insect infestation, extraneous material, off-odors, off-flavors, and off-colors.

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3.2.1 Beef. The beef shall be from steers, heifers, or cows and shall be derived from any one or any combination of the following USDA Certified Institutional Meat Purchase Specifications (IMPS) cuts: Item Number 114 (chuck, shoulder clod), 115 (chuck, square-cut, boneless), 128 (chuck, cross-cut, boneless), 133 (triangle, boneless), 161 (round, shank-off, boneless), 163 (round, shank-off, 3-way, boneless), 165 (round, rump and shank-off, boneless), 167A (knuckle, peeled), 169 (top round), 170A (bottom round, heel-out), and 171B (outside round). All beef shall be certified by a USDA, Agricultural Marketing Service (AMS) agent to certify condition of the product and compliance with the IMPS Quality Assurance Provisions.

3.2.1.1 Handling and storage. Handling and storage of the boned and trimmed beef, prior to processing into the finished product, shall be in accordance with the following requirements:

a. Beef processed on the day of initial certification shall be maintained in the temperature range of 28° to 50°F (inclusive).

b. Holding in the fresh chilled state for not more than 4 days after initial certification is permitted provided the beef is maintained in the temperature range of 28° to 40°F (inclusive).

c. Holding in the frozen state for not more than 180 days after initial certification is permitted provided that the beef is:

-frozen to 0°F or lower within 72 hours after initial certification
-stored at 0°F or lower
-protected from freezer deterioration and damage
-stored in containers that are adequate to maintain product excellence.

d. Tempering/thawing of frozen beef shall comply with the following:

-microwave tempering/thawing of frozen beef is permitted provided excellent condition of the beef, as determined by the USDA, is maintained
-the microwave tempering/thawing process shall not exceed 48 hours from time of removal of the beef from the freezer to further preparation
-regardless of the process used, frozen beef shall be tempered/thawed to a temperature not to exceed 40°F
-when a tempering/thawing process other than microwave is used, the time from the start of the tempering/thawing process (removal from freezer) to further preparation shall not exceed 96 hours
-beef which has been tempered/thawed shall not be refrozen.

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3.2.2 Beef patties, cooked or raw, individually quick frozen (IQF). The beef patties shall have been prepared from chilled (not previously frozen) beef meeting the requirements of 3.2.1 and 3.2.1.1. The beef patties shall have been processed in accordance with paragraphs 3.3.1 and 3.3.2. Raw or cooked IQF beef patties shall be packaged and sealed in USDA approved food packaging material. Raw packaged beef patties shall have been held at an internal temperature of 0°F or below for a period not to exceed 60 days prior to further processing. Cooked packaged beef patties shall have been held at an internal temperature of 0°F or below for not more than 90 days prior to tray pack filling. IQF beef patties (raw or cooked) shipped between plants shall be accompanied by a USDA Agricultural Marketing Service (AMS) Certificate to certify the initial freezing (in-storage) date and compliance with the above stated requirements.

3.2.3 Broth/stock, beef, canned (thermostabilized), frozen or dehydrated. The canned (thermostabilized), frozen or dehydrated beef broth/stock shall be produced from USDA inspected beef in accordance with USDA Meat and Poultry Products Inspection Regulations. The canned, the frozen, and the dehydrated beef broth/stock shall be free from extraneous material and cracklings. The canned or frozen beef broth/stock shall be clear and essentially fat free. The canned and the frozen beef broth/stock shall be concentrated, have a characteristic mild-beef broth/stock odor and flavor and may contain flavor enhancers approved by FDA. The dehydrated beef broth/stock shall have a minimum of 93 percent total solids, a maximum of 1 percent fat and may contain flavor enhancers approved by FDA. The canned and the dehydrated beef broth/stock shall be of the latest date of pack. The frozen beef broth/stock shall have been held at 0°F or below for a period not to exceed 75 days prior to tray pack filling.

3.2.4 Onion powder. Onion powder shall be Fancy Grade of the Official Standards and Methods of the American Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Association (ADOGA) for Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Products.

3.2.5 Pepper, black, ground. Ground black pepper shall be derived from the deep brown to black, deep-set, wrinkled, immature berries of Piper nigrum L. The ground pepper shall have a characteristic penetrating odor, a hot, biting, pungent flavor and a light gray to speckled black-gray color. The ground pepper shall contain not less than 2.0 mL of volatile oil per 100 grams of ground black pepper and shall be of such size that not less than 95 percent passes through a U.S. Standard No. 16 sieve.

3.2.6 Protein, soy, concentrate. The soy protein shall be a textured soy concentrate and shall comply with the following (see 6.4):

1. Chemical Characteristics:

a.	Protein (N x 6.25) moisture free basis	70.0% (min)
b.	Moisture	8.8% (max)

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c.	Fiber, crude	4.5% (max)
d.	Ash	6.0% (max)
e.	Fat (American Oil Chemists Society Method BE 3-49)	1.0% (max)
f.	Caramel color, double strength	0.2 to 1.0% 1/

1/ Twice the amount of single strength may be used to meet this requirement.

2. Flavor Characteristics:

a. Shall receive a flavor score of 6.0 or higher when tested in accordance to the provisions of the USDA Northern Regional Research Laboratory Odor and Flavor Intensity Scoring Scale of the Cereal Panel Odor and Flavor Evaluation System.

b. Shall have no additional flavor added.

3.2.7 Salt. Salt shall be noniodized, white, refined sodium chloride with or without anticaking agents and shall comply with the purity standards for sodium chloride of the Food Chemicals Codex.

3.2.8 Sodium tripolyphosphate. Sodium tripolyphosphate shall comply with the Food Chemicals Codex.

3.2.9 Water. Water used for ice making, formulation, and washing shall conform to the National Primary Drinking Water Regulations.

3.2.10 Preblended spice and seasoning mixture. Preblended spices and seasonings may be used. The spices and seasonings in the mixture shall comply with the requirements of this document. The containers used for the spice and seasoning blend shall be labeled with each ingredient and the percentage of each ingredient in the blend. The ingredients shall be in the same proportions as specified in the ingredient formulation.

3.3 Preparation and processing. Processing shall be on a continuous basis.

3.3.1 Beef preparation. Boned and trimmed beef meeting the requirements of 3.2.1 shall be further trimmed, if necessary, to ensure compliance with finished product requirements. The beef shall be coarse ground through a plate with holes measuring 1 inch in diameter. The ground beef shall be held for not more than 24 hours at an internal temperature of 28° to 40°F prior to beef patty preparation.

3.3.2 Beef patty preparation. The beef patties shall be formulated and prepared as follows:

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Ingredient	Percent by weight
Beef	94.90
Water	2.50
Salt 1/	1.20
Onion Powder	0.50
Soy protein concentrate	0.50
Sodium tripolyphosphate	0.30
Pepper, black, ground	0.10

1/ The total amount of salt in the formula shall be adjusted as necessary to produce a product that complies with the finished product salt requirement (see 3.6).

a. The tripolyphosphate shall be dissolved in a portion of the water and thoroughly mixed with the coarse ground beef.

b. The remaining dry ingredients (except soy protein) shall then be thoroughly mixed with the tripolyphosphate beef mixture.

c. The remaining water and soy protein concentrate shall be combined to form a mash and the mash shall be thoroughly mixed with the spice/tripolyphosphate beef mixture.

d. The beef patty mixture shall be ground through a 5/32 inch plate.

e. The beef patty mixture shall be cooled sufficiently to avoid patty "hang-up" in the patty forming equipment (see 6.5).

f. The beef patty mixture shall be formed into patties measuring approximately 4.25 inches in diameter and approximately 0.42 inches thick and weighing approximately 4 ounces.

g. The beef patties shall be maintained at an internal temperature of 28° to 40°F for not more than 12 hours from time of forming to beginning of the IQF process (see 3.2.2) or to the browning (cooking) process.

h. Beef patties shall be partially cooked (surface browned) to produce a medium brown color, a charbroiled flavor, and to comply with the finished product requirements (see 3.6 and 6.6). Deep fat frying, steam, or water cooking is not permitted.

i. Cooked beef patties shall be maintained at an internal temperature of 28° to 40°F for not more than 48 hours from time of cooking to beginning of the IQF process (see 3.2.2) or to tray pack can filling. Beef patties previously frozen in the raw state shall not be frozen. Cooling of the beef patties is not necessary if can filling occurs immediately after cooking.

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3.3.3 Broth preparation. The beef broth (see 3.4b) shall be prepared as follows. Broth shall be prepared fresh daily. Broth remaining at the end of a production day shall be discarded.

a. Canned beef broth/stock shall be adjusted with water to a soluble solids content of between 3 and 4 percent.

b. Frozen beef broth/stock shall be completely thawed and then adjusted with water to a soluble solids content of between 3 and 4 percent.

c. Dehydrated beef broth/stock shall be completely hydrated and then adjusted with water to a soluble solids content of between 3 and 4 percent.

3.4 Tray pack filling and sealing. Each tray pack can (see 5.1.1) shall be filled with product such as to conform to the finished product requirements and to the following requirements:

a. Each tray pack can shall be filled with not less than 18 intact beef patties, stacked 3 patties per stack and 6 stacks per can.

b. The tray pack can with beef patties shall be filled with hot or cold beef broth to a total can content weight of 106 ounces.

c. Immediately after filling, each can shall be hermetically sealed under a vacuum established by a processing authority and specified in the scheduled process so as to assure compliance with the finished product requirement (see 3.6q).

d. The filled and sealed tray pack cans shall be in the retort process within 2 hours after sealing.

3.5 Tray pack thermoprocessing. The filled and sealed tray pack cans shall be thermostabilized by retorting at a temperature of 250°F or below until a sterilization value (F_o) of not less than 6 has been achieved.

3.6 Finished product requirements. The finished product shall comply with the following requirements.

a. There shall be no foreign material such as, but not limited to, dirt, insect parts, hair, wood, glass, or metal.

b. There shall be no foreign odor or flavor such as, but not limited to, stale, sour, rancid, or moldy.

c. There shall be no color foreign to the product.

d. Total weight of cartilage, coarse connective tissue, section of tendons or ligaments, and glandular material, collectively, in a can shall be not more than 1 ounce.

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e. No individual can shall contain a bone piece measuring 0.3 inch or more in any dimension.

f. Each can shall contain not less than 18 intact beef patties.

g. Beef patty texture shall not be dry, rubbery, tough, or mushy.

h. Beef patties shall retain their shape.

i. Drained weight of 18 intact beef patties shall be not less than 51.0 ounces.

j. The average drained weight shall be not less than 53.0 ounces.

k. The average total can content weight shall be not less than 106 ounces.

l. No individual can shall have a total can content weight of less than 104 ounces.

m. The average fat content of the finished product shall be not greater than 12.0 percent.

n. No individual tray pack shall have a fat content greater than 14.0 percent.

o. No individual tray pack shall have a salt content less than 0.8 percent or greater than 1.3 percent.

p. The product shall show no evidence of excessive heating (materially darkened or scorched).

q. Filled, sealed and retorted cans shall show evidence of proper vacuum as determined by concavity of the can lid (see 4.5.6).

3.6.1 Palatability. The finished product shall be equal to or better than the preproduction sample (see 6.1) in palatability and overall appearance.

3.7 Plant qualification. The beef component and the finished product shall originate and be produced, processed, and stored in plants regularly operating under Meat and Poultry Inspection Regulations of the U.S. Department of Agriculture.

3.8 Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act. All deliveries shall conform in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

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4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Contractor's responsibility. Inspection and acceptance by the USDA shall not relieve the contractor of obligation and responsibility to deliver a product complying with all the requirements of this specification. The contractor shall ensure product compliance prior to submitting the product to the USDA for any inspection.

4.2 Inspection and certification. Product acceptability shall be determined by the USDA. The USDA will determine the degree of inspection and supervision necessary to ensure compliance with the requirements of this specification.

4.3 Classification of inspection. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

a. First article inspection (see 4.4).
b. Quality conformance inspection (see 4.5).

4.4 First article inspection. When a first article is required (see 6.1), it shall be inspected in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of this specification and evaluated for overall appearance and palatability. Any failure to conform to the quality assurance provisions of this specification or any appearance or palatability failure shall be cause for rejection of the first article.

4.5 Quality conformance inspection. Unless otherwise specified, sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

4.5.1 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1, components and materials shall be inspected in accordance with all the requirements of referenced documents unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified, or qualified in this specification or applicable purchase document.

4.5.1.1 Ingredient and component examination. Conformance of ingredients and components to identity, condition, and other requirements specified in 3.2 shall be certified by the ingredient supplier or ingredient manufacturer, and compliance shall be verified by examination of pertinent labels, markings, U.S. Grade Certificates, certificates of analyses, or other such valid documents acceptable to the inspection agency. If necessary, each ingredient shall be examined organoleptically or inspected according to generally recognized test methods, such as the standard methods described in the Official Methods of Analysis of the AOAC and in the Approved Methods of the American Association of Cereal Chemists, to determine conformance to the requirements. Any nonconformance to any identity, condition, or other requirement shall be cause for rejection of the ingredient or component lot or of any involved product.

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4.5.2 In-process examination. In-process examination shall be performed to determine conformance to the preparation, processing, can interior coating, filling, sealing, and packaging requirements. Any nonconformance revealed by actual examination or by review of records of time, temperature, and formulation or of other valid documents shall be cause for rejection of the involved product.

4.5.3 Tray pack inspection. The inspection lot shall include only tray packs produced in one workshift. The USDA reserves the right to separate the inspection lot into smaller inspection lots.

4.5.3.1 Total can content weight inspection. Randomly select 30 filled and sealed tray pack cans from the inspection lot and weigh separately. Subtract the average tare weight (determined by randomly selecting and weighing 30 of the empty tray pack cans and lids used in preparing the product and dividing the total weight by 30) from the weight of each tray pack in the sample. The results shall be reported to the nearest 1 ounce. If the average total can content weight is less than 106 ounces or if the total can content weight of any individual can is less than 104 ounces, the lot shall be rejected.

4.5.3.2 Double sampling plan for product inspection. The finished product shall be examined for the defects listed in table I utilizing the double sampling plans indicated in MIL-STD-105. The lot size shall be expressed in tray pack cans. The sample unit shall be one filled and sealed tray pack can. The inspection level shall be S-3 and the acceptable quality level (AQL), expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 4.0 for major defects. The sample cans shall be heated in accordance with heating instructions on the can label.

TABLE I. Product defects 1/ 2/

Category	Defect
Major	
101	Total weight of cartilage, coarse connective tissue, section of tendons or ligaments, and glandular material, collectively, in a can is more than 1.0 ounce.
102	Presence of a bone piece measuring 0.3 inch or more in any dimension in an individual can.
103	Drained weight of 18 intact beef patties in a can is less than 51.0 ounces. 3/ 4/
104	More than one beef patty did not retain its shape.

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TABLE I. Product defects 1/ 2/ (cont'd)

Category	Defect
Major	
105	Texture of beef patties is dry, rubbery, tough, or mushy.
106	Can contains less than 18 intact beef patties.
107	Product shows evidence of excessive heating (materially darkened or scorched). 5/

1/ The presence of foreign material (for example, glass, dirt, insect parts, hair, wood, metal), foreign odor or flavor (for example, moldy, rancid, sour, stale), or foreign color shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

2/ Product not equal to or better than the approved preproduction sample in palatability and overall appearance shall be cause for rejection of the lot (see 3.6.1).

3/ To determine drained weight, the free liquid in the can shall be poured off and the remaining contents shall be poured into a flat bottom container. A minimum of three times the tray pack can's volume of 180° to 190°F water shall be added to the container so as to cover the contents. The contents and water shall be agitated so as to liquify rendered fat and remove broth without breaking the beef patties. The contents shall then be poured into a U.S. Standard 1/2-inch sieve in a manner that will distribute the product over the sieve without breaking the beef patties. Sieve area shall be such that the distributed product does not completely cover all the openings of the sieve. The sieve shall be tilted at approximately a 45 degree angle and allowed to drain for 2 minutes before determining the drained weight by subtracting the sieve tare weight from the gross weight. Eighteen intact beef patties shall be weighed to determine the drained weight. Results shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 ounce.

4/ If the sample average drained weight is less than 53.0 ounces, the lot shall be rejected.

5/ Slight scorched marks due to broiling, particularly on the fringe of the patties, shall not be considered a defect (see 3.3.2).

4.5.3.3 Fat and salt content testing. Three filled and sealed tray packs shall be selected at random from the lot. The tray pack cans shall be individually tested for fat and salt content in accordance with the Official

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Methods of Analysis of the AOAC, method numbers 960.39 and 935.47, except that preparation of the samples shall be as follows: The unopened tray pack cans shall be gently warmed in a water bath to melt fat adhering to the inside of the cans. The cans shall be opened and thoroughly drained of all broth. Each can of drained beef patties shall be separately blended in a Waring Blendor or equivalent. The test results shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 percent. Any result failing to conform to the fat and salt requirements in 3.6 shall be classified as a major defect and shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

4.5.4 Can condition examination. Examination of filled and sealed tray pack cans shall be in accordance with the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers, except that inspection for labeling shall be in accordance with 4.5.4.1. In addition, scratches, scuffs, or abrasions that occur on the outside coating as a result of the filling, sealing, and thermoprocessing of the tray cans shall not be scored as a defect.

4.5.4.1 Can label examination. Labels shall be examined for defects in accordance with MIL-L-1497 (see 5.4), except, that for self-adhering labels, the following additional defects shall apply:

Major: Label torn or scratched so as to obliterate any of the markings.

Minor: Air bubbles under label.
Label not properly adhered to can, for example, label raised or peeled back from edges or corners.

4.5.4.2 Label adhesive examination. When self-adhering labels are used, the adhesive shall be tested in accordance with ASTM D 3330.

4.5.5 Can closure examination. Can closures shall be examined visually and by teardowns in accordance with the can manufacturer's requirement and 21 CFR, Part 113, Subpart D, or 9 CFR, Part 318, Subpart G, as applicable. Any nonconformance based on observation of can seam teardowns or on record of can seam teardowns shall be classified as a major defect and shall be cause for rejection of any involved product.

4.5.6 Vacuum examination. Cans shall be allowed to cool to $75^{O} \pm 5^{O}F$, held for at least 24 hours after sealing, and then examined for vacuum retention. To examine, lay a straight edge in the center of the lid along the length of the tray pack. Both ends of the straight edge shall touch the lid at the inside edge of the double seam. There shall be a visible gap between the straight edge and the lid for the entire distance of the label panel. Using a shorter straight edge, the same procedure shall be used across the width, in the center of the tray pack can. One measurement shall be made when examining a ribbed lid; lay the straight edge between the two center ribs along the length of the can. The inspection lot shall include only tray packs produced in a single shift on a single sealing machine. The sample size shall be 50 cans. Any nonconformance shall be classified as a major defect and shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

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4.5.7 Shipping container examination. Shipping containers shall be examined for defects in assembly, closure, and reinforcement (when applicable) in accordance with PPP-B-636. In addition, the following defects shall be classified as follows:

Major: National stock number, item description, contract number, or date of pack markings missing, incorrect, or illegible.
Reinforced with other than nonmetallic strapping or tape.
Dimensions of pads not as specified.
Interior packing with fiberboard liner or pads not as specified.

Minor: Other required markings missing, incorrect, or illegible.
Arrangement or number of cans not as specified.

4.5.8 Unit load inspection. Inspection of unit loads shall be in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of MIL-L-35078.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Preservation. The product shall be preserved in accordance with level A.

5.1.1 Level A. The food product shall be filled into a tray pack can conforming to MIL-C-44340 and sealed and thermoprocessed as specified in 3.4 and 3.5.

5.2 Packing. The product shall be packed in accordance with level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.1).

5.2.1 Level A packing. Four cans of product, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard box, constructed and closed in accordance with style RSC-L or HSC-L with a HSC full depth cover, grade V2s of PPP-B-636. The cans shall be packed flat, four in depth within the box, with the first two cans placed with the lids together and the next two cans with the lids together. The inside of each box shall be provided with a box liner and five fiberboard pads fabricated of grade V3c fiberboard. The height of the box liner shall be equal to the full inside depth of the box (+0 inch, -1/8 inch). Flute direction of the box liner shall be vertical. The pads shall be placed between the cans and on the top and bottom of the stacked cans. The pad dimensions shall be not less than 1/8 inch of the full length and width dimensions of the box. Each box shall be reinforced with nonmetallic strapping or pressure-sensitive adhesive filament-reinforced tape in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636. Shipping containers shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with MIL-L-35078 for the type and class of load specified (see 6.1) except that the unit load shall consist of 48 boxes with 12 boxes per course and four courses per load with all courses having the same pattern. Boxes may be stacked by interlocking and reversing

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each tier, or by columnar stacking with paperboard or fiberboard sheets placed between each tier. When unit loads are strapped, strapping shall be limited to nonmetallic strapping, except for type II, class F loads.

5.2.2 Level B packing. Four cans of product, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed as specified in 5.2.1 except the box shall be constructed of grade V3c, V3s, or V4s fiberboard.

5.2.3 Level C packing. Four cans of product, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard box, constructed and closed in accordance with style RSC-L, class domestic, grade 275 of PPP-B-636. The cans shall be packed flat, four in depth within the box, with the first two cans placed with the lids together and the next two cans with the lids together. The inside of each box shall be provided with a box liner and five fiberboard pads. The height of the box liner shall be equal to the full inside depth of the box (+0 inch, -1/8 inch). Flute direction of the box liner shall be vertical. The pads shall be placed between the cans and on the top and bottom of the stacked cans. The pad dimensions shall be not less than 1/8 inch of the full length and width dimensions of the box and shall be fabricated of class domestic, grade 175 fiberboard.

5.3 Unit loading. When specified (see 6.1), the product, packed as specified in 5.2.2 or 5.2.3, shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with MIL-L-35078 for the type and class of load specified except that the unit load shall consist of 48 boxes with 12 boxes per course and four courses per load with all courses having the same pattern. Boxes may be stacked by interlocking and reversing each tier, or by columnar stacking with paperboard or fiberboard sheets placed between each tier. When unit loads are strapped, strapping shall be limited to nonmetallic strapping, except for type II, class F loads.

5.4 Labeling. Each tray pack can shall be labeled in accordance with MIL-L-1497 and with the following:

- Official establishment number (e.g., EST 38) or a three-letter code identifying the establishment.
- Lot number 1/
- Production shift number 1/
- Retort identification number 1/
- Retort cook number 1/

1/ The lot number shall be expressed as a four digit Julian code. The first digit shall indicate the year of production and the next three digits shall indicate the day of the year. (Example, March 19, 1990 would be coded as 0078.) The Julian code shall represent the day the product was

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packaged and processed. Sub-lotting (when used) shall be represented by an alpha character immediately following the four digit Julian code. Following the four digit Julian code and the alpha character (when used), the other required code information shall be printed in the sequence as listed above.

In addition, the name of the product shall be marked, stamping is permitted, on one 1001 by 200 end of the can. The labeling shall be legible when examined as specified in 4.5.4 after preparation of product in accordance with heating instructions. Paper labels are not permitted. Cans shall show the following statements:

TO HEAT IN WATER: Submerge unopened can in boiling water. Simmer gently 25 minutes. Avoid overheating (can shows evidence of bulging).

CAUTION: Use care when opening as pressure may have been generated within the can.

TO HEAT IN OVEN: Either punch several holes in lid of can or open can in usual manner leaving the loose lid in place. Place in a 350°F oven 30 minutes.

WARNING: Do not place unopened can in oven. This may cause the can to burst.

YIELD: Serves 18 portions of 1 beef patty each.

As an alternate labeling method, a pre-printed self-adhering 0.002 inch thick clear polyester label printed with indelible black ink may be used. Self-adhering labels shall be applied after retorting. Pressure-sensitive adhesive shall require no preparation prior to application. Labels shall tack quickly and adhere without curling or breaking. The adhesive shall have a minimum adhesion of 60 ounces per inch width when examined as specified in 4.5.4.2. When self-adhering labels are used, the tray pack can shall be labeled with the Julian code and a product code prior to retorting.

5.5 Marking

5.5.1 Shipping containers. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or purchase order, shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

5.5.2 Unit loads. Unit loads shall be marked in accordance with MIL-L-35078. In addition, the following precautionary marking in capital letters larger than other markings shall be included:

CAUTION: DO NOT STACK PALLETS IN TRANSIT OR MORE THAN TWO HIGH IN STORAGE, UNLESS PALLET RACKS ARE USED.

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6. NOTES

(This section contains information of a general or explanatory nature that may be helpful, but is not mandatory.)

6.1 Acquisition requirements. Acquisition documents must specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this specification.
b. Issue of DODISS to be cited in the solicitation, and if required, the specific issue of individual documents referenced (see 2.1.1 and 2.2).
c. When a first article is required (see 3.1, 4.4, and 6.2).
d. Provisions for approved preproduction samples (see 3.6.1 and 6.2).
e. Level of packing required (see 5.2).
f. Type and class of unit load when unit loading is required (see 5.2.1 and 5.3).

6.2 First article. When a first article is required, it shall be inspected and approved under the appropriate provisions of FAR 52.209-4. The first article should be a preproduction sample. The contracting officer should specify the appropriate type of first article and the number of units to be furnished. The contracting officer should also include specific instructions in acquisition documents regarding arrangements for selection, inspection, and approval of the first article.

6.3 Appropriate level of pack. Based on the conditions known or expected to be encountered during shipment, handling, and storage of the specific item being procured, the procuring activity should select the appropriate level of pack in accordance with the criteria established in AR 700-15/NAVSUPINST 4030.28/AFR 71-6/MCO 4030.33A/DLAR 4145.7.

6.4 Soy protein concentrate. It has been found that product number 7181 and Response 4412, manufactured by Central Soya, P.O. Box 1400, Fort Wayne, Indiana 46801-1400, meets the requirements of 3.2.6 and performs satisfactorily in this product.

6.5 Beef patty preparation. It has been found that a patty mixture temperature of approximately 33°F is sufficient in helping to increase binding and to avoid patty hang-up. Dry ice pellets may be used during mixing if necessary to control patty mixture temperature.

6.6 Beef patty cooking. It has been found that beef patties that have been partially cooked to a yield of 85 to 93 percent in a gas broiler or a hot air impingement oven meet the finished product requirements.

6.7 Subject term (key word) listing.

Canned foods
Combat field feeding

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Rations
Shelf stable

6.8 Changes from previous issue. Marginal notations are not used in this revision to identify changes with respect to the previous issue due to the extensiveness of the changes.

Custodians:

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 50

Review activities:

Army - MD, QM
Navy - MC
DP - SS

Preparing activity:

Army - GL

(Project 8940-0728)

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

INSTRUCTIONS

1. The preparing activity must complete blocks 1, 2, 3, and 8. In block 1, both the document number and revision letter should be given.
2. The submitter of this form must complete blocks 4, 5, 6, and 7.
3. The preparing activity must provide a reply within 30 days from receipt of the form.

NOTE: This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, or clarification of requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements.

I RECOMMEND A CHANGE:	1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT DATE (YYMMDD)
	MIL-B-44353A	1992 September 30

3. DOCUMENT TITLE

BEEF PATTIES IN BROTH, THERMOSTABILIZED, TRAY PACK

4. NATURE OF CHANGE (Identify paragraph number and include proposed rewrite, if possible. Attach extra sheets as needed.)

5. REASON FOR RECOMMENDATION

6. SUBMITTER

a. NAME (Last, First, Middle Initial)	b. ORGANIZATION	
c. ADDRESS (Include Zip Code)	d. TELEPHONE (Include Area Code) (1) Commercial (2) AUTOVON (If applicable)	7. DATE SUBMITTED (YYMMDD)

8. PREPARING ACTIVITY

a. NAME	b. TELEPHONE (Include Area Code)	
U.S. Army Natick RD&E Center	(1) Commercial 508-651-4501	(2) AUTOVON/DSN 256-4501
c. ADDRESS (Include Zip Code) Commander, U.S. Army Natick RD&E Center ATTN: SATNC-WTP Natick, MA 01760-5018	IF YOU DO NOT RECEIVE A REPLY WITHIN 45 DAYS, CONTACT: Defense Quality and Standardization Office 5203 Leesburg Pike, Suite 1403, Falls Church, VA 22041-3466 Telephone (703) 756-2340 AUTOVON 289-2340	

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